



5. Identify and secure logistics capacity, estimating capacity and accelerating, where possible, and being flexible on transportation mode, when required.
6. Manage cash and net working capital by running stress tests to understand where supply-chain issues will start to cause a financial impact.

Dikshit further explains that the pandemic gave birth to a new market, which demanded products that do not require physical touch to be operated. These products, as per him, became possible only because of the digital technologies available in the market.

“We continue to get inquiries from Marquee brands about the availability of touchless switches that can be deployed in consumer electronics like air-conditioners. Providing hands-free experience to end users continues to remain a part of strategies that were born out of the pandemic,” Dikshit says.

There are two kinds of companies in the world when it comes to deploying IoT—those that are proactive, and others that are reactive. Proactive companies were able to deal much better with the pandemic than the reactive ones. Dikshit explains that the percentage of proactive ones in India is less than one.

Tamboli adds that when working on a digital strategy, one should not approach the same with words like IoT,

but with a problem solving approach. He says, “Don’t lead with words like IoT, but lead with the problem that you want to solve, and the things will fall in place.”

Mckinsey, in a report, states that manufacturers who are using digital transformation to develop new or enhanced ways of operating their businesses have recorded 30 to 50 per cent reduction in machine downtime, 15 to 30 per cent improvement in

labour productivity, 10 to 30 per cent increases in throughput, and 10 to 20 per cent fall in the cost of quality. Most of these have included data, computational power, and connectivity—such as sensors, the Internet of Things, cloud technology, and blockchain—as a part of their digital strategies.

Having a digital strategy in place in times when the old rules are no longer applicable becomes important even for the employees working in an organisation. “Having and clearly communicating a strong strategic vision for the company in the midst of both acute and chronic disruption helps employees know how to respond when digital disruption changes the environment. When the old rules are no longer applicable—whether temporarily suspended due to Covid-19 or because technology moves faster than regulation—it’s important that employees know which overarching principles are guiding their work,” reads a report by Deloitte Insights.

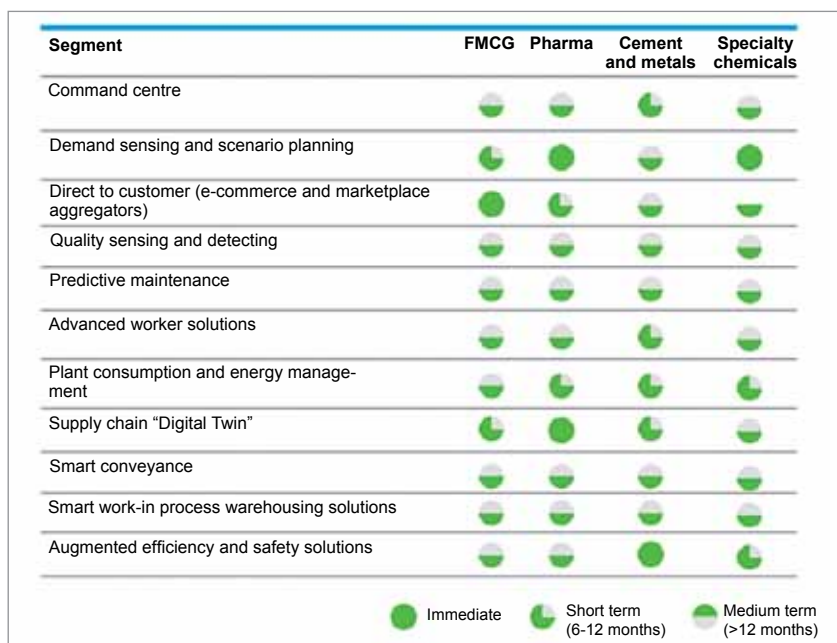


Figure 3: Relative relevance of advanced technology use cases across industries in a post-Covid-19 scenario (Source: Deloitte)